

# Class Notes: Class Aves

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

## Flight Adaptations

Characterised by wings and flight ability (except flightless birds like ostrich); have beaks; forelimbs modified into wings, hind limbs used for walking/swimming/clasping branches. Skin is dry with oil glands only at the base of the tail; endoskeleton ossified with hollow, pneumatic long bones.

## Reproduction and Examples

Respiration by lungs and air sacs; digestive system has crop and gizzard as additional chambers; heart four-chambered. Homoiothermous (warm-blooded); internal fertilisation, oviparous, direct development, sexes separate. Examples: Corvus (crow), Columba (pigeon), Psittacula (parrot), Struthio (ostrich), Pavo (peacock), Aptenodytes (penguin), Neophron (vulture).